

PEACEMAKERS

* Blue denotes PPT slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

Matthew 5:1-12 (KJV) *“And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him: 2 And he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying,*

3 Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

4 Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.

5 Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth.

6 Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled.

7 Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.

8 Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

9 Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.

10 Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

11 Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake.

12 Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.”

INTRO: Here in Matthew five Jesus lays out eight markers for believers to self judge ones on spiritual maturity. Each of the eight are immediately followed by a promised blessing.

The beatitudes are:

- Proverb like...
- Without narrative...

- Cryptic...
- Precise...
- Full of meaning...

Each of the beatitudes mirrors a major Biblical theme. The theme I want to point to today is ***“Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.”***
(Vs. 9)

All of us have either had situations, now have situations, or will have situations in our lives where we will need to exercise our right to act like daddy God and be a peacemaker.

Note: There is a big difference between being a peacekeeper and being a peacemaker! Peacekeepers are people pleasers and are willing to give up their core values to keep the peace! (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) (Example: A woman willing to quit going to church

and serving Jesus to please an unsaved husband)

Peacemakers find a way to make peace without compromising their core values.

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) (Example: Jesus faced the pressure to conform to the worlds system but rather than caving in to keep the peace He went to the cross and made the peace!)

I would like to point out four things a peacemaker will be required to do in the peacemaking process. If we do these things we will make peace wherever we serve and people will begin to recognize we are the children of God!

I. CHOOSE YOUR BATTLES CAREFULLY!

In this world criticism comes with the territory. People often misunderstand your intentions, develop false assumptions from

less than limited information, and question your character.

Sometimes it's not necessary to come down off the wall and speak to everything. Your friends don't need an explanation and your enemies won't believe you anyway.

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

You may have the footing, the right and the ammunition to take care of business but that isn't always the right course to take.

A peacemaker knows, nothing is worth a broken relationship. Because we understand this, we choose to react in a way that allows the relationship to remain, while creating a path to resolution.

Peacemakers are fully aware of the value of people...

II. CAREFULLY CHOOSE YOUR REACTION...

When the need for peacemaking presents itself it is almost always at a time when emotions are running high, and hostilities are everywhere.

Sure, you could set people straight, set the record straight, demand your way, etc...

Peacemakers carefully guard:

- Their words...
- Their reactions...
- Their body language...
- Their facial expressions...

Peacemakers understand that a wrong step in any one of these disciplines can ruin the peace process by shutting down the engagement of the individual(s) involved.

This is true in:

- Marriage...
- Child rearing...

- Professional careers...

Sometimes peacemakers have to hold their peace and allow the Lord to fight their battles. (Story about this)

Peacemakers know that **once words are spilled into the atmosphere they can never truly be taken back. (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** They're like a feather pillow that explodes. Months later feathers are turning up out of nowhere!

Peacemakers choose to react with Christian respect to everyone because they know that what really counts are the people who are involved.

III. TREAT PEOPLE WITH DIGNITY...

Regardless of what people do to you, keep a sweet spirit. Love everyone! (That doesn't mean you have to go on vacation with them)

Don't just take the high road! Take the highest road. (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) (Example: Staff members who have left throwing sand in the air)

Peacemakers know two wrongs never make a right, and always bear in mind, the people are what really counts!

IV. PEOPLE NEVER DEPRECIATE...

(Buy a new car – Drive it 30 day's – Have it appraised)

Things depreciate but people never do. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) The worlds system depreciates people based on the following things:

- Net worth...
- Color of skin...
- How old they are...
- How young they are...

- Connections or lack of them...

In the God world two things last forever:

- God's Word...
- The human soul...

CONCLUSION:

Matthew 5:9 say's "*Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.*" In other words people will recognize us as the children of our Father because we have gone beyond keeping the peace to making the peace!

Think of this:

- Jesus served...
- Jesus healed...
- Jesus comforted
- Jesus fed the hungry...
- Jesus ministered to the people...
- Jesus redeemed the multitudes...

He was:

- Cursed...
- Beaten...
- Mocked...
- Misquoted...
- Misunderstood...
- Ultimately murdered...

Yet, He continued with the peace process!

Peacemakers never give up on the situation!

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)

Do you have a situation in your life that is begging for the skills a peacemaker could bring to the table? If so, I want you to come forward today! (Once they come to the altar, explain that we are going to ask the Lord to transform each of them into the needed peacemaker!)